5.9.5 Feet and nails.

The feet and nails require special attention to prevent infection, odours, and an injury to tissue. People are unaware of foot or nail problems until pain or discomfort occurs. Problems may result from poor care of the feet and nails such as biting nails or trimming them improperly, exposure to chemicals and wearing poorly fitted shoes.

5.9.6 Care of feet and nails.

1) Inspect the feet daily including the tops and soles of the feet and the area between the toes.
2) Wash and soak the feet daily using luke warm water (37° C).
3) If the feet perspire, apply a bland foot powder.
4) If dryness is noted along the feet, apply soft oil and rub gently into the skin.
5) File the toe nails straight across and square.
6) Avoid wearing elastic stockings.
7) Wear clean socks daily.
8) Do not walk barefoot.
9) Wear properly fitted shoes.
10) Exercise regularly to improve circulation to the lower extremities.
11) Immediately wash minor cuts and dry them thoroughly. Mild antiseptics may be applied to the skin.
12) Cut the nails trimly and keep it clean and tidy.



Nail cutting



Highlights

Walking is the best exercise for your feet, and it's also a great way to get overall exercise for your body: it boosts circulation and helps to burn calories. Standing still is a way more tiring than walking, because only a few muscles are used when you are still standing, whereas walking distributes the weight and effort over more muscles.

STUDENT'S ACTIVITY

Practice nail care.

Fact

One quarter of your body's bones are in the feet. A normal foot has **33 joints, 26 bones, 19 muscles, and 107 ligaments.**

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